on the Assam Rifles post. The Chinese had positioned anti-tank guns behind the fortifications prepared during the last three days, and these now started firing in a bid to destroy the stone sangars. As soon as the shelling stopped, Chinese infantry began to close in on the defenders. The concentrated bombardment amongst the rocks had been terrifying and the men had dug as deep as they could. They were hardly able to breathe as cordite fumes filled the already rarefied air. But the stone fortifications held, despite sections being blown away by direct firing RCLs.